

# The Cheese Grater

The Other Student Magazine of University College London Union



No. 6  
October 2005

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# Down Your Union



**Union won't support climate change protests but will help Nestlé turn a profit...  
Our political hack's view on exciting events in student affairs**

**Dex Torricke-Barton**

**UCL UNION** leaders have refused to endorse the resolution of a motion lending support to a London demonstration on climate change, citing legal restrictions.

In a motion submitted to the Welcoming General Meeting of UCL Union, students requested that a delegation and banner be dispatched to the London Climate Demonstration on 3 December 2005, an event planned to coincide with planned Montreal Climate talks as part of "an international day of climate protest." But in a meeting of the Governance Committee of UCL Union, a consensus of union executive and non-executive officers claimed that sending the banner and delegation would "contravene the principle of the Union operating in a position *super partes*" and that "the timing to coincide with a round of talks and the explicitness of the demo's political orientation made it such that the Union could not send an official representation." This is a suspect interpretation of the law. But it is also cowardly. A whole host of student union leaders up and down the country – as nearby as Malet Street – have always dared to advocate the nirvana of 'the campaigning

union.' The idea that a student union's key function is to play a role in articulating and supporting the political vision of its members. None of these organisations have ever duelled with the law. Not one executive officer has been thrown in the chokey for daring to take a banner along to a march, even a political one. And even if this had happened, it still wouldn't nullify the moral responsibility that a union has towards its members to campaign and take a stand.

**Luca Manfredi**



The decision not to send a banner is inconsistent. Last year, students voted to send a banner to the European Social Forum 2004. Executive happily complied with the decision. And no-one got prosecuted.

And finally, can't climate change be regarded as something beyond politics? Doesn't the health of our environment

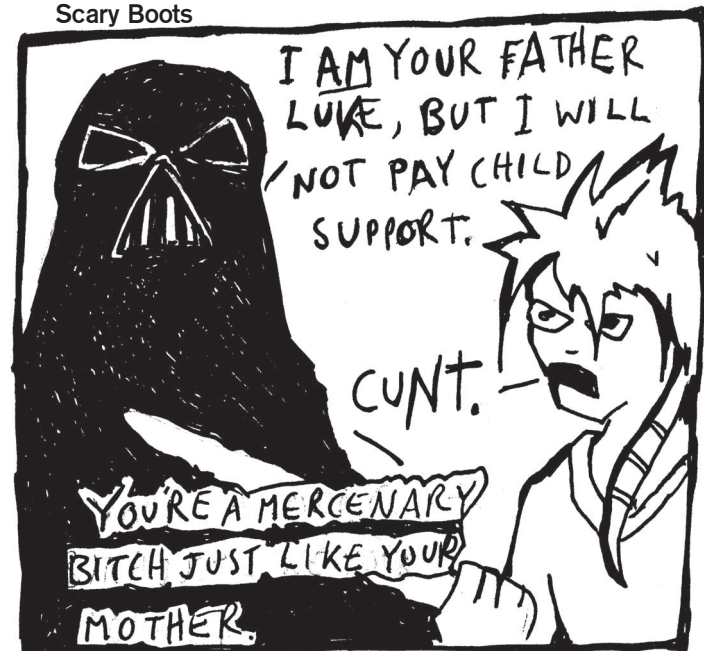
and our planet constitute something that is of interest to all peoples, including students as students? I mean, isn't this just a sheer, bloody-minded laziness in refusing to endorse the march?

"It is not about the Union being like GW Bush. It is about keeping away from street politics, be they good or bad" said General Secretary Luca Manfredi in defence of the decision. Well that says it all doesn't it. 'Be they good or bad.' For fuck's sakes.

## Have a break

AN ATTEMPT to lift

Scary Boots



UCL Union's ban on sale of Nestle products in its outlets was quashed at the Welcoming General Meeting on 11 October. This is strange.

The original ban on Nestle products was imposed on 22 March 2004, after a packed general meeting voted to join the International Nestle Boycott (INB) campaign. The campaign alleges that the company has pursued unethical marketing practises in the developing world, specifically relating to the marketing of powdered milk products. The resulting ban on Nestle products at UCLU was supported by two former Environment and Ethics Officers, and the current holder of the position, Louise Broadbent.

Broadbent came out as an enthusiastic advocate of the ban during her election in March, and her efforts to renew the original motion took no-one by surprise. But what is truly baffling is how little resistance she





encountered from her more commercially-inclined colleagues. The Nestle ban is a dull piece of union legislation that does nothing to actively support the ban – students can simply walk to Tottenham Court Road to get their Kit Kats – and denies a valuable income stream. The strategy of the INB is nebulous at best, and misguided at worst. And even if these two facts weren't true, the union is certainly taking some sort of political judgement on the facts of the Babymilk case.

Given the obsession with remaining apolitical at UCL Union, this really doesn't add up.

## Addio Luca?

**LUCA MANFREDI** seems to be getting a lot of heat lately. A controversial candidate in the UCLU and ULU elections of last year, opponents have always tended to label him as a homophobic, sexist, discriminatory brute – claims that found credence thanks to his persistent gaffes on the union's website messageboards. But despite an almost self-consciously quiet online profile since the start of term, the critics are back. And this time they brought friends. Friends with political firepower.

It must be the nightmare scenario for any union hack;

winning an election only to find that no-one else has stopped fighting, and being incapable of moving on to actually doing the job. And thus the rug has been pulled out from under Luca's feet with credible rumours of a no-confidence motion being prepared against him at ULU Council. The culprits? An executive source in the know at ULU claims that members of the student LGBT community are doling out retribution.

At 25 Gordon Street, Luca's ambitious plans for a re-write of the standing orders and union constitution seem to be going nowhere. Perhaps it's reform ennui by last year's officers. Nigel Harris, the former General Secretary, made a big thing of changing the standing orders and became almost a 'reform bore'. But more likely, it's simply down to Luca's sinking political stock.

At the WGM on 11 October, a faint thud could almost be heard as it hit rock bottom. A plucky student sought to relieve Luca of his chairmanship of the meeting. And even though the attempt failed, Luca appeared shaken. He should be. His executive colleagues are likely to take his policy proposals even less seriously with the cratering of his political credibility. And the result is likely to be the total failure of all his

**Contributors:** Nikolai Morofski, Scary Boots, Rusty Wood, Mark Ravinet, David Hing, Dex Torricke-Barton, Patrizia Papitto, Nigel Hunckleberry, Claude McNab, Eva von Datta, bird, Mr Chatterbox

best laid plans at the two places he was elected to serve.

Harsh. But that's politics.

## DonlonStundet

"YOU CAN DO A lot of things as London Student Editor," avid *London Student* hack Chaminda Jayanetti told readers of his manifesto for editor, during the ULU elections in March.

"You can plug your political line (yes, there's more!). You can bang on about student unions. You can even write all the articles yourself. But that doesn't mean you should."

This might come as a surprise to the latest *LS's* readers. Of all the columns in the news section he edits, he has written 268 centimetres, compared to 556 cm by, er, everyone else.

But perhaps Cham is just making up for lost time. While on work experience at the *Camden New Journal* this year, he doesn't appear to have got anything published.

## Clarification

LAST issue's (March) article 'Golders' Green secedes' featured comments attributed to UCL student and then Jewish Society president Samuel Lebens. None of these comments were said by him and they were entirely invented, the article itself reporting fictitious events, namely the formation of a Jewish state in north-west London.

We should have checked with Sam before publishing this article, and regrettably we did not. For this, we have already apologised to Sam - Ed.

## Student Squad

Exclusive strip from our members at DingBobik Comics  
[www.dingbobikcomics.co.uk](http://www.dingbobikcomics.co.uk)



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- Senior figure confirms £600k price
- Academic grumbling over rebrand
- UCL management shocked at idea of including students

**UCL's corporate rebranding has attracted a lot of attention in recent months. Now you can read exclusive information from those responsible...**

#### Mr Chatterbox

THE NEW, eagerly awaited UCL brand, which replaced the old portico logo, was unveiled two moths ago to a fanfare of universal apathy and bemused disdain. The new logo, in a slab-sided typeface, stands alongside that a slogan that is arguably meaningless and vapid – 'London's Global University'. The Provost, Professor Malcolm Grant, and the communications team at UCL have been working on the rebranding of the college since before the beginning of the last academic year; but it took almost a year after the unveiling of the "Campaign for UCL" (launched last November with a temporary logo) for the new logo to be made public.

The fact that the logo was released so late, alongside the fact that it has been rumoured to cost the college £600,000 (*London Student* said this, but they got it from the AUT teachers' union website; *The Cheese Grater* heard it mentioned by a source close to the Provost himself) has raised concerns that the whole process was bungled by College. Senior sources within UCL's communications team have vigorously denied that the logo cost £600,000 and argue that extensive market research that led up to the rebranding identified UCL's problem as being an ignored, misunderstood and "stuffy" college within the University of London and other Russell Group universities.

The Development and Corporate Communications team have been refreshingly candid as to their aim to increase the "brand awareness" of UCL internationally, especially in America, and give a modern, competitive edge to



**The Provost with (clockwise from top) the crests of KCL, Imperial, Cambridge and Oxford. UCL has none, and the new logo certainly sets it apart.**

UCL in the fight for research grants. UCL is currently stood at 25<sup>th</sup> place in the 2004/05 international league table they use (one place behind Imperial College) and it is Professor Grant's ambition to replace Oxbridge as Britain's premier. However alarm bells have begun to ring at all levels of the university with regard to what is seen as the "marketisation and corporatisation" of UCL, in preference to what was seen as the previous prestige logo and image which relied upon the college's history and founding philosophy.

One student commented that it was a shame that Malcolm Grant had forgotten (or ignored) the Harvard academic and aesthete Professor Elaine Scarry's comment that "a university is among the precious things that can be destroyed", and expressed a worry that the new logo was purely designed to appeal to win research grants rather than appeal to the brightest and best of UK students.

Sources tell us there is considerable grumbling amongst the college academic

staff about many of the proposed changes; grumbling which certainly surfaced at the 2005 graduation dinner for honorary graduates. There was an expressed sense within the college that its soul has been quietly wrestled away from them but little political will to take on of another Provost after such a short tenure. Many academics were particularly angry because they perceived that 'UCL plc' feels such little regard for the college that they regard its very name, which reflects the fact they were the founding college of the University of London, as an "historical inconvenience": a fact confirmed by the communications team which explained that University College London was a title confusing to potential American students and investors, who did not know whether UCL was a university or college. Hence the fact that from now on the college will be referred to purely as UCL – which, as John Sutherland points out, is often thought to stand for the University of Central London.

The decision itself on the

final branding was made by the Provost and his management team with what could be seen as perfunctory liaison with students and even less with alumni of the university. Shockingly even those with a vested interest in UCL's brand, such as UCL Union, were not consulted in any meaningful sense and its officers were left angry by the fact the lack of consultation. They were presented, *The Cheese Grater* has learned, with a done deal like the rest of the student body and forced to acquiesce.

Our sources within the development office have informed us that during the process of re-branding, roughly 800 self-selected students participated in an online consultation; over 1,500 alumni were also involved; the Union Sabbatical Officers were also consulted. They were shown a variety of logos, all of which looked fairly similar to each other. *The Cheese Grater* has found no evidence to suggest that any methodology was used to weight the result in order equally represent each department or faculty. Furthermore,





**The Campaign for UCL banners in autumn 2004, with what now looks like an interim UCL logo**

they admit, this was just to identify the problem rather than find a solution. More extensive research was conducted with external bodies rather than students or potential stu-

dents, a decision based on both cost and the fact that UCL is a “research-led institution”, not primarily an educational establishment. One angry student involved in the process described it as a “disgraceful sham designed to cover the college’s back”. When questioned Purbah Choudhury, UCL’s deputy director of corporate communications, found the idea that students themselves should be involved in the decision of which brand image to select “extraordinary”.

However the research amongst students revealed that the student body and the college agreed upon the problem: that UCL does not have an identity at home and abroad that can match Oxford and Cambridge or even Imperial and LSE. Moreover the trouble is that while UCL wants to compete with those universities it is perceived as competing with lesser universities such as Bris-

tol and Warwick because their reputations are over-estimated while UCL’s is underestimated. However looking at both UCL’s real and perceived competitors, the majority have gone for a “modern prestige” logo which combines both modernity with a sense of prestige. Unlike UCL.

The communications team have claimed that while rebranding they faced a difficulty in that unlike many other old universities, they had no crest upon which to base a future logo. They did, however, have UCL’s founding motto, ‘cuncti adsint meritaque expectent praemia palmarum’ (‘let all come and receive the reward of victory and merit’). Apparently this meant nothing to them.

Meanwhile the fact that UCL’s new logo has opened up the college to ridicule and talk of crisis, has angered many UCL students, aggravated since

much of this mockery has come from King’s College (another *perceived* competitor) and *London Student*. Indeed recently one or two graduates expressed doubts as to whether they would support *UCL Friends*, the previously successful alumni fundraising programme, based on what was seen as the new ‘UCL plc’ image.

Previous Provosts have got into trouble when they have tried to rebrand the college and Professor Grant was no doubt aware of this when he bravely went about the process. However he thought that his rebranding solution would settle UCL’s future, *The Cheese Grater* is afraid that he is very much mistaken.

*Watch this space for further information on the new UCL*

\*Vergil, *Aeneid* book 5, line 70.

# Alternative UCL campaign launched

## UCL undergraduate challenges Provost to rethink UCL’s future, scrap the new logo, devolve power and even listen to students...

### Exclusive

A UCL undergraduate has challenged Provost Malcolm Grant’s Campaign for UCL – and the rebranding and restructuring of College now in progress – by launching an ‘Alternative Campaign for UCL’.

Graham Kirby said he was launching the campaign because he disagreed profoundly with the direction of UCL’s future and he wanted to give students the power to help determine it. “As top-up fees are being introduced, students are being seen increasingly as stakeholders. All our reputations lie on the successful prestige of UCL. However, while we have the most to lose, we are given no say in UCL’s future”.

Kirby is particularly unhappy about the new UCL logo – already mocked by the *AUT* and *London Student* – and the Provost’s lack of accountability. Explaining his aims, he said: “At the core of the campaign is asking the Provost to reconsid-



**Graham Kirby**

er his decision to rebrand the College; asking him to meet students and present his ideas, and put them forward for democratic discussion”. He objected to the “corporate management spirit” of the new logo, concerns also reflected in our article on the subject in this issue.

Kirby, 27, a third-year politics student at SSEES, appears to have a small follow-

ing at the moment, but his plans are big: he wants to ask the Provost to reconsider his decision to rebrand College; ask him to meet students and present their ideas, including a new logo (bottle of Bollinger champagne for the winner); and put them forward for democratic discussion – taking power away from the Provost.

Kirby did not shy away

from the last point: “Scottish universities have elected figures, elected by the students and graduates, who have an influential role in decisions, and I’m calling on UCL to adopt the same role”. Challenged that he didn’t know what he was talking about, he admitted: “OK, the Provost does know more about higher education; however, what I’m asking is for the Provost to treat us like adults, with all the facts before us.”

Kirby insisted that students would be encouraged to participate in the campaign since their careers were at stake. “Every one of us will have ‘UCL’ next to our names for the rest of their lives. That can either be a millstone – if we’re apathetic – or a blessing.” He was anxious to present himself as a friend to the Provost and praised the Campaign for UCL for its ambition, but finished with an appeal: “One can’t make decisions from an ivory tower. If the Provost has confidence in his ideas, let him come forward and debate them.” **RL**

# Tragedy at Campbell House

Hall residents speak out on Steven MacDonald's death earlier this year

Deceased's room  
now inhabited  
Resident attacks  
management's  
'disgraceful' conduct

Nigel Hunckleby

THE HORROR of new students at the quality of the bathrooms, the kitchen wildlife and the leaky ceilings in Campbell House East was overshadowed last month by something far more shocking. Details were revealed through an article in *London Student*, which residents plastered on doors throughout the house. This was the first confirmed information about the death in Campbell House East of mature student Steve McDonald in June. Rumours had been circulating, but no official information had been released by either UCL or the Campbell House management.

The management apparently thought that this was a matter of too little importance to be communicated to the current inhabitants of Campbell House East, especially the ones who have to live in his room less than three months after he died there. The management are a miracle of judgement: they have even less faith in the investigative powers of *London Student* journalists than they deserve (the article let off the management lightly, and named someone who wished not to be), but even they forgot about the astounding power of inter-college gossip. In order to get rid of the misinformation that has been circulating by gossip or the *London Student* article, former inhabitants of Campbell House East and some other sources who prefer to remain anonymous provided *The Cheese Grater* with the following facts.

At the start of the first term, MacDonald, 44, taking a BSc degree in palaeobiology,



UCL's Campbell House East in Taverton Street, WC1, where MacDonald's body was found

was acting oddly. He was hostile at times, made other students feel uncomfortable, and several inhabitants complained about his behaviour to the management. However, his behaviour took a turn for the worse around Christmas: he stopped attending lectures, stopped washing and eating, was seen drunk regularly in the halls, and was sick in the toilets. According to several accounts, his skin actually acquired a green hue, and concern started to spread. The management forwarded the case to the Dean of Students, Professor John Foreman..

What happened next is unclear. On being asked what was going on, the halls management said it was in the Dean's hands; according to a resident who spoke to them, a halls manager said she'd reported it to the Dean and that he did not look too concerned. We were not able to check this with Campbell House management as they refused to comment. Despite his increasingly difficult conduct, the management refrained from contacting the police. MacDonald was last seen around a week and a half before term ended. By this time a strong smell was coming from the basement. The cleaners had thought this was due to large amounts of rubbish, but after clearing it away, it did not go. The cleaners carried on as be-

fore. On July 10<sup>th</sup>, after the term had ended, the door of his room was finally, which its opener regretted as they discovered what lay behind it. Whatever it looked like, Campbell House is frequented by rats. According to a police report left lying on a halls windowsill his is being treated as a 'sudden death', possibly of a heart attack caused by alcohol abuse.

Since then, no official statements have been made about it; no-one in Campbell House East has been told anything about it by the management; no-one has asked the Dean about his handling of the case, with whom the welfare buck stops; no press articles have been published except in *London Student* and as from today, *The Cheese Grater*. This deep and unanimous silence is peculiar, since the media would be the first to pick up on anything even remotely resembling a scandal. It is difficult to escape feelings of a cover-up.

Asked about the events, The Dean of Students repeated his response to *London Student*: "I have prepared a full report on the circumstances relating to the death of Mr MacDonald for the Provost. A copy was also sent to the Coroner." He stated that the cause of death was not yet known, and insisted that "Several welfare support agencies were in-

volved and made strenuous efforts to provide assistance to Mr MacDonald, including me." In declining to comment further, he stated that the personal issues relating to McDonald are confidential.

.Whatever did happen to Steven MacDonald, a remarkable wall of silence has predominated at Campbell House since June. The halls management are meant to keep his room empty but have re-occupied the room as though nothing had happened. Their residents, however, are unlikely to forget in a hurry.

## CheeseGrater Award for Joined-up Journalism

"I wasn't surprised when, at my first NEC meeting...the Alliance for Workers' Liberty launched their attack on NUS President Kat Fletcher".

(Jamal El-Shayyal, London Student, 20th September)

"I was also astonished by the AWL's attack on NUS President Kat Fletcher".

(Jamal El-Shayyal, London Student, 20th September, 24 lines down on the same page)



# Provost's ex-moustache a force for good in the world

Whatever happened to the Provost's moustache after it was shaved off on 11 March 2005? Rusty Wood narrates a tale of unwanted hair made good



The tache enjoying a trip to the British Museum

IT'S NOT EASY moving out, especially not after 33 years of living on the face of some really famous guy. Many find the experience extremely tough and find themselves dealing with it in ways they thought they never would. But, as Malcolm Grant's ex-moustache has shown, it doesn't have to be the end of things.

"At first I felt very lonely.

*'I think you know we asked you to comMIT suicide'.*



At night there was no rhythm of snoring interspersed with the phlegm filled splutters of a middle-aged man. It was just quiet, and very cold."

M, as he likes to be known, initially turned to the more hedonistic ways of life in order to come to terms with his loss. "I thought I'd seen a lot on Malc's face, but it turns out there's much more interesting things in this world. I think I've done every massage parlour in North London. I had a tab at Spearmint Rhino, too. But then, I woke up one day and looked in the mirror and I saw what I looked like. Untended, increasingly grey, straggly bits everywhere. I felt like I'd let everyone down, including myself. And I said to myself "no, I'm not going to grow out my days like this". Since then, I've been a changed tache."

The turnaround couldn't have happened without a helping bristle or two, though. "I'm in love", M says, sharing a moment with his new found

partner. "I met her in the UCL Shop, on the woman who runs it and gets pissed off if you turn up at the wrong time for an internet connection voucher. But I liked that fight, it's a sign of virility, you know".

Since then, M and his partner have travelled the world trying to help other taches with the transition from face to independence. "It was a cause very close to us, having both been recently made homeless, and we wondered how other taches were coping. We were lucky we found each other, but what if others aren't as lucky as us? It's hard to cope without any 'Just For Men' colouring, you see yourself as who you really are. And sometimes you don't like that. But, you know, just being there to listen, or giving a little brush can really make a difference to people's lives. Especially to the muffs, they find it really hard. I'm a little surprised they don't already have a support network because they're the highest pro-

portion of skinless hairs around. Women think that once it's down the drainpipe it's all over, but it isn't. And we have to pick up the Veet-coated strands."

M's support network isn't just limited to hairs, though. "A group of us went to New Orleans to help plug the gap in the levees. FEMA [the Federal Emergency Management Agency] was very grateful. But now they seem to have it under control, we're going to head off to Pakistan to help with the search. Our bristles can be very sensitive so we've found that emergency workers are really keen for us to come on board. We're light, too, so we don't crush any babies or anything. Ha ha, only joking."

*If you know any hairs who are struggling to come to terms with shaven emancipation, or are yourself trying to deal with it, please contact the Tache Support Network's 24 hour hairline on 08975 S-K-I-N-L-E-S-S.*

*'I'm sorry darling, but even though you killed Daddy with your Xbox, you can't revive him by starting a new game'.*







# UCL Union announces new theme nights

Any resemblance between this theme night and last year's theme night is entirely coincidental.

**This year's entertainments from your Union are even more imaginative than usual...**

**Mark Ravinet**

WITH THE new term comes a new schedule of entertainment from the ever hard-working officers of UCL Union: sabbatical officers and student reps alike have used the summer break to produce a programme of themed events to entice even the most hardened fresher.

Despite suffering the loss of nearly half the capacity of the main union building, UCLU staff endeavoured to secure the Windeyer bar to house the alcohol-based life consolation habits of the typical student. Coupled with the loss of several drinking promotions, in particular the demise of Vodka 99s, improving the events has been no mean task. However UCLU's Services and Events officer 'rolled with the punches' and has cunningly recycled all the old theme nights from last year.

"It took some time to come up with," Williamson told *The Cheese Grater* in a gutter in Crouch End, "but we realised that since none of the freshers were around last year they probably wouldn't be too bothered." Indeed, with the roaring success of Chav night last year, seeing students from

middle-class backgrounds dressing up to mock those less fortunate than themselves, the merry sabbatical officer hardly needed to conjure up any new themes. "If it ain't broke, don't fix it as they say," chortled Williamson. "Chav night was just too good not to use again. It was really a good effort all round, some of the freshers looked just like the real deal, happily blowing their giro cheques on cheap booze!"

In an opportunity to further the extent to which students can merrily waste Government loans, Williamson and his colleagues have concocted a brand new theme for Mondays. The first 'Home Counties' night at the Windeyer is scheduled for 21<sup>st</sup> of November. "I can't wait, it's going to be a real old boys knees up!" enthused the sabb.

Given the popularity of past events, the new themed evening is undoubtedly going to be as equally outrageous. Already the night is causing a stir amongst UCL students. Alexander Tiddlington-Smith, (Philosophy II) said, "It's going to be bloody mad mate! I don't know what to wear though; I was thinking a rugger shirt and a blazer."

**Patrizia Papitto**





# TimeOut

## Student



**The side of the National Film Theatre on the South Bank, with Nothing projected onto it. (See Cinema)**

### Bars

#### Ugg Bar

28 Notting Hill Gate, London W9 4EE 020 7925 6001 Web: [www.uggerbugger.com/good-nightout](http://www.uggerbugger.com/good-nightout) Open 6pm - 12am

Mon-Sat.

If you are ugly and have the conversational skills of a tumble drier, this bar is where you should be. It is dark, the music is loud, and the drinks all have a high alcohol content. After 11pm those who are facially challenged but compensate with humour will also be admitted.

Partially funded by the WBYNS (We are Beautiful You are Not Society) and GQ magazine as part of their 'Clean Up Our Streets' initiative, The Ugg Bar provides a haven for like-faced people to go and be ugly together without upsetting those more fortunate. It also provides relief on the streets of London where the beautiful people will be able to go out on a Friday night and not be chatted up by the short guy with bad teeth. You may spot what the bar has deemed its "Honorary Uggs" who in-

clude Chris Evans, Rick Waller, Bruce Forsyth and Jodie Marsh.

Remember your ID – the bouncers have been briefed not to take your ugliness at face value. Students will need to show their ID card (this provides as a good indication of your true appearance as you blatantly forgot it was picture day when you turned up for enrolment).

We give this 4 paper bags out of 5. It seems like a good idea for all ugly people. And anyway, why do you think you can afford to be so picky anyway? If you don't like this place I suppose there's always your room with the curtains closed.

### Cinema

#### Nothing by Friedrich Von Trapp

*Museum of Moving Image, South Bank complex, SE1 8XT Web: [www.bfi.org.uk/museum](http://www.bfi.org.uk/museum). Embankment/Waterloo Tube. FREE admission. Until November 8th*

After leaving the Von Trapp family singers due to heavy ketamine usage on the tourbus, Friedrich turned his hand to filmmaking. Specialising in not actually using any video inside his video recorder, Von Trapp's work emphasises the temporal nature of moving image media. This, combined with the vacuous state of his mind, leads to some unexpected results.

Please note: For those who cannot locate the Museum of Moving Image, or get there only to discover it was closed in 1999, *Nothing* will be projected onto the side of the National Film Theatre, every Monday, 5pm-1am.

compiled by Eva von Datta and Hannah Hudson

# How to pull freshers

Jaded impoverished finalists! Have no fear! This tried and tested chat-up routine will have the fresh meat leaping out of their stupid fucking hats...

**Nikolai Morofski**

"HEY, whats your name?

....Really, that is a cool name, didn't/did expect that from someone who looks like they are Indian/Chinese/European/



from Somerset. Where are you from?... Woah, well I am not quite from such an exotic place, just Oxford, you know... 50 miles away from here... yeah we don't do much there, there is a kebab van on Saturday for when the pubs shut but apart from that... well yeah it used to have some industry but now it's all university, you're right...

yeah all my friends that went there have become tosspots too, I agree... I know we should have got in... it's a shame.. a travesty one might say... so what are you doing?... woaaaaoh.. well you are certainly sorted out with a job after that... I mean at least you know where you are going... Oh I am just doing philosophy... 3rd year.. yeah still don't



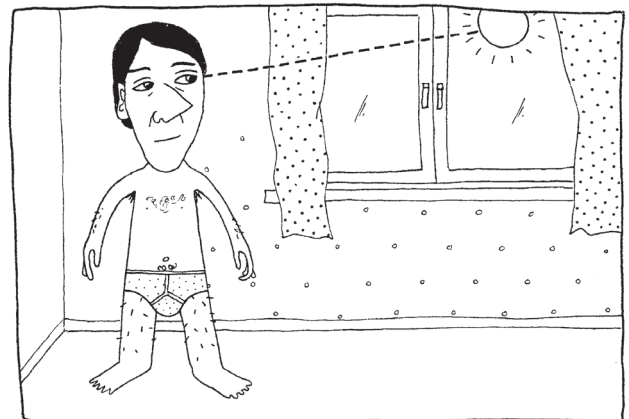
know what I want to do with it... thing is with philosophy you can do anything... and yet you have nothing to do... so consider yourself lucky, it may seem hard... but at least... you

know, KPMG will be interested in you after you graduate... [pause]

That's a nice hat... yeah what is it with hats these days, everyone is wearing them... Niklas.. you met him right, says Topshop is doing those... oh you got it from Topshop did

you... GREAT STORE.... yeah... really... really... really... unpretentious...

So, what was your number again?  
Oh.



When I wake up in the morning, I like to look directly at the sun, making myself blind for another day.

# Kampf und die Kursteilnehmer

Claude McNab

COULD A modern student spend hours in a feverish state, in thin clothes, lying on a sofa in a dark, dank, poorly furnished room, turning over in their mind some vague half-formed ideas about lice and Napoleon? Could they then plan and execute the bloody murder of a mean pawnbroker and moneylender? Would they use an axe? Could they then undergo a conversion experience under the influence of a beautiful but delicate girl called Sofia?

Isn't it a shame that they couldn't?

The historian Arnold Toynbee claimed that conditions of "ease" hinder the development of civilisation. The thesis has been widely criticised, but when it comes to creativity he might have had a point, even if he never realised it. How many great writers, intellectuals and artists have spent their intellectual formative years getting pissed? Several, perhaps, but they all did it in the spirit of genuine wanton self-destruction which is in itself a form of artistic expression, and which is sadly rare



nowadays.

You see, modern students have it far too easy. Instead of worrying about whether they have enough money to pay their months-overdue rent to their evil landlady without pawning their last possession apart from their threadbare winter coat, they worry about whether they can afford to get pissed tonight. And they always "can," even when they can't. When they go out, they go out together in groups of friends, socialising and engaging in such frivolous activities as having fun and relaxing. The Nietzschean super-student on the other hand "goes out" in the following manner.

## What is wrong with today's students?

i) Wanders out of sub-sub-let room without putting on coat (despite cold air and weak chest), because in feverish daze.

ii) Walks down streets of European city, without noticing where he is going.

iii) Enters dingy bar where various archetypal low lives are assembled.

iv) Spends last penny/centime/kopek/pfennig/forint on drink.

v) Engages in conversation with one of aforementioned low lives. This will illuminate some aspect of student's life, art or thought.

etc.

I do not necessarily endorse Raskolnikov's particularly homicidal brand of nihilism. However, it does occur to me that, unlike Dostoevsky's most famous protagonist, modern students fall sadly short of the standards demanded of the *uberkursteilnehmer* (super-student) by Nietzsche in his classic work on the subject, *Kampf und die Kursteilnehmer*.

Why go the pub, drink too much, and *fall over*, when you can follow in the footsteps of the great, and *step-over*?

## SocietyBitch



Starting this issue, our round-up of less well-known club and society activity...

"UCL STUDENT behaves like drunken public schoolboy" is right up there with "Bear shits in woods" in news terms. However, it's worth reporting, as it seems to be the European Society's idea of attracting new members. On their pub crawl on Wednesday 5th October, vice-president Rod Mamudi and a friend of his accosted a fresher and proceeded to grope various parts of her body. They then looked shocked when her friend called them a pair of cunts, put her drink down and left.

Heard of Pirate Soc? No? Fair enough, it doesn't exist. But they tried, albeit badly. Formed by some intrepid ex-Ramsay Hall inmates, they decided it would be fun to go on pub crawls dressed as pirates, and...er...that's it. Having utterly misunderstood how to form a society, they hung around at Freshers' Fayre trying to get signatures before being thrown out by security.

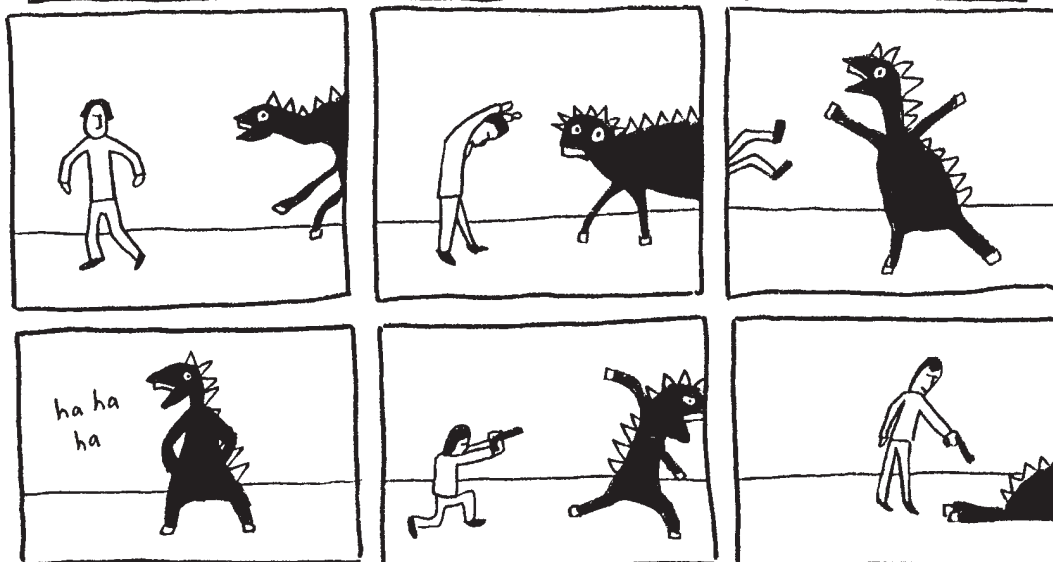
Undaunted, they held their first meeting. One exhibit turned up and said something like, 'Oh, i just went to the first Conservative Society meeting dressed as a pirate, they thought it was odd, haw haw haw...' He proceeded to get rat-arsed, get his cock out and urinate *while* wandering down the Euston Road, with a procession of pirate devotees behind him.

Hold on to your members, Lacrosse Club!

Send your gossip to [cheese\\_grater\\_magazine\\_society@ucl.ac.uk](mailto:cheese_grater_magazine_society@ucl.ac.uk). All information treated in confidence.

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Friday, September 30, 2005

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**EXCLUSIVE**

Only in today's Daily Mail

# Halfway attractive pair of girls murdered

BY OUR ENTERTAINMENT STAFF

LIZZIE Winner and May Chervallier were found severely killed all over London yesterday in a horrific and unprovoked attack.

A man is being held on suspicion of what police have termed a serial molestation killing (SMK). Lizzie, 17, with a bright future ahead of her in the telesales sector, was found fatally dead by police at the scenes of the crime: her head was in Collindale, a foot in Belsize Park and her left tit in Wood Green. Paramedics failed to resuscitate her at any location. A forensic examination suggests the wounds are consistent with the use of a meat cleaver, several MAC 10 bullet sprays and the wheels of a 7-seater mini-cab.

The suspected killer was apprehended after he attempted to sell the body of May to a kebab shop in Hackney. At the time of going to press the likelihood that the suspect was a foreign asylum seeker has already been established but not precisely how much in benefits he sponged off the state before taking the lives of two innocent angels; buy the Evening Standard on your way home for more details.

Upon being told the details of the deaths, friends of Lizzie commented "fuck off



**Joy: The Pitcairns celebrate the anniversary of their leaving Melbourne, and success in providing us with another photo utterly unrelated to the article.**

shitheads, can't you see we're upset" while May's fellow pupils at Saint Rabbi Mohammed's Multi-Faith Academy began crying profusely and were unable to comment. Lizzie's parents later issued an official statement through their cat: "This is a very hard time for us, but we take some solace that our Lizzie's final hours have reached the front page, bringing paranoia and fear to people all over London - we feel it is what she would have wanted. The

commuters will be thoroughly entertained and at least they did not have to run with rising petrol prices on the front page again. We thank the Metro for respectfully describing our baby's death amongst the adverts for 2 for 1 offers at Marks and Spencer and Lastminute.com holiday deals."

**ON PAGE 4:** How molestation killings affect petrol prices: full analysis

## CULTURE

**Alex Kapranos - my first scanner**



## LOCAL

**Sutton Council cracks down on chav gerbil**

## TRAVEL MOTORING

**Paris-Stalingrad: The ups and downs of nostalgia tours**

